

# Haeseong Park

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University of Colorado Boulder  
 Department of Economics  
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## EDUCATION

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|--------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| <b>Ph.D. Economics, University of Colorado Boulder</b> | <i>May 2027 (expected)</i> |
| <b>M.A. Economics, University of Colorado Boulder</b>  | 2023                       |
| <b>M.A. Economics, Sungkyunkwan University</b>         | 2020                       |
| <b>B.A. History, Sungkyunkwan University</b>           | 2016                       |

## FIELD OF INTERESTS

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Environmental Economics, Urban Economics, Labor Economics

## JOB MARKET PAPER

### **Urban Economic Structure and Disaster Resilience – The Role of Labor Markets, Road Networks, and Trade Linkages**

Agglomeration generates economic benefits by concentrating economic activity, but whether these same urban structures amplify or mitigate vulnerability to natural disasters remains unclear. I examine how the effects of natural disasters vary with industrial composition, road networks, and trade linkages across U.S. metropolitan areas. Natural disasters reduce local economic activity by approximately 3 percent on average. Valuing the associated loss in electricity service, the median estimated economic loss is equivalent to approximately 14 percent of monthly MSA GDP. The effect varies substantially with urban structure. The decline is more than twice as large in MSAs with greater industrial concentration, while it is around half as large in MSAs with more centralized road networks and stronger intra-city goods sourcing. The relationship with industrial concentration also depends on where that concentration occurs. Disaster impacts are smaller where concentration is greater in Manufacturing, but larger where concentration is greater in Accommodation, Wholesale Trade, and Transportation and in Health and Education. These findings show that the effects of natural disasters depend systematically on the preexisting organization of urban economic activity, making resilience an important dimension of how the benefits and costs of agglomeration are evaluated.

## WORKING PAPERS

### **Who Bears the Cost of Staying Urban? – Skill-Differentiated Migration Responses to Natural Disasters**

This paper examines how natural disasters shape migration responses of high-skilled and low-skilled workers across metropolitan and rural areas in the United States. I measure within commuting zone migration using a binary location choice framework that accounts for disaster conditions in both the current place of residence and potential next destinations. Using disaster driven monetary losses, I find that a one percent increase in four year cumulative disaster damage growth raises out migration of low-skilled workers from metropolitan areas by 1.44 percentage points, while high-skilled inflows rise by 0.63 percentage points. I also consider a measure of relative spatial disaster exposure, defined as the likelihood

that surrounding areas experience greater damage than the focal location. A one percentage point increase in this measure raises low-skilled population growth in rural areas by 2.58 percentage points over four years and 1.79 percentage points over five years, while generating no comparable response in metropolitan areas. Overall, the results show that natural disasters reinforce skill based spatial sorting, shifting low-skilled workers away from urban areas, with implications for unequal access to the opportunities provided by cities and longer run inequality across skill groups.

## WORK IN PROGRESS

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Local Economic Structure and Young Firm Survival After Disasters

Mobility-Driven Economic Interdependence and the Spatial Propagation of Disaster Shocks

## RESEARCH & TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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### Research Assistant, The Rocky Mountain Research Data Center (RMRDC)

- Graduate Research Assistant *Aug 2023- Present*
- Instructor, Graduate Course on Federal Data for Health Research and Policy *Spring 2024, Spring 2025*

### Instructor of Record

- Principles of Macroeconomics, CU Boulder *Summer 2025*
- Natural Resource Economics, CU Boulder *Fall 2025*

### Teaching Assistant

- Principles of Microeconomics, University of Colorado Boulder *Fall 2021, Fall 2022-Spring 2023, Fall 2026*
- Principles of Macroeconomics, University of Colorado Boulder *Spring 2022, Spring 2025*

### Professional Service

- Organizer, Graduate Student Seminar, University of Colorado Boulder *Fall 2024-Present*

## SCHOLARSHIPS, AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

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|                                                                           |             |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Graduate School Travel Grant, University of Colorado-Boulder              | <i>2026</i> |
| Graduate School Summer Fellowship, University of Colorado-Boulder         | <i>2026</i> |
| Bacon Family ECON Graduate Scholarship, University of Colorado Boulder    | <i>2025</i> |
| Third Year Paper Prize, University of Colorado Boulder                    | <i>2024</i> |
| Reuben A. Zubrow Fellowship in Economics, University of Colorado Boulder  | <i>2024</i> |
| Graduate Award for Public Policy Research, University of Colorado Boulder | <i>2023</i> |
| Bacon Family ECON Graduate Scholarship                                    | <i>2022</i> |

## PRESENTATIONS

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### 2026:

Urban Economics Association Summer School 2026 London  
 Western Economic Association International 101st Annual Conference  
 20th North American Meeting of the Urban Economics Association

Souther Economics Association 96th Annual Meeting (Scheduled)

**2025:**

Successfully Navigating Your Economics PhD workshop, AEA Committee on the Status of Women in the Economics Profession (CSWEP) South, Southern Economics Association (SEA)

University of Colorado Boulder Graduate Student Seminar

University of Colorado Boulder Applied Economics Seminar

University of Colorado Boulder Environmental Economics Seminar

**2024:**

14th Annual Front Range Energy and Environmental Economics Camp

University of Colorado Boulder Environmental Economics Seminar

University of Colorado Boulder Graduate Student Seminar

**2023:**

13th Annual Front Range Energy and Environmental Economics Camp

University of Colorado Boulder Environmental Economics Seminar

**SKILLS/LANGUAGES**

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|                              |                                   |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| <b>Programming Languages</b> | Stata, Python, MATLAB, R, SAS     |
| <b>Languages</b>             | English (Fluent), Korean (Native) |

**NATIONALITY**

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Republic of Korea (U.S. F1 visa)

**REFERENCES**

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*Advisor*

**Prof. Jonathan Hughes**

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*Committee Member*

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